

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Truck and Delivery Driver English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Truck drivers, local delivery drivers, and driver helpers.

All cases, names, quantities, schedules, and company arrangements are fictional English practice, not driving, loading, cargo-handling, legal, or safety training. Service terms and duties vary. Follow employer training and applicable requirements; refer vehicle operation, access safety, claims, fees, and regulatory decisions to responsible qualified people. Phone conversations take place while parked, never while driving.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Confirming the delivery destination

Resolve conflicting location details using names and reference numbers.

02 Checking shipment counts

Report a quantity discrepancy without inventing its cause.

03 Updating an arrival estimate

Give a delay message with an explicit unresolved booking.

04 Describing a delivery exception

Agree factual wording while preserving the receiver's concern.

05 When the recipient cannot receive

Identify what can be arranged within the customer's constraints.

06 Explaining the booked service boundary

Explain a service mismatch and offer a booking review.

07 Matching a return to its collection

Clarify the identity and quantity of goods offered for collection.

08 Closing a route with a clear handoff

Provide enough detail to avoid an unnecessary repeat delivery.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Confirming the delivery destination

Resolve conflicting location details using names and reference numbers.

CASE

Shipment 418 names Alder Books at 26 Mill Street, suite 4. The route note says rear annex. The receiver confirms that the annex belongs to suite 6; suite 4 uses the staffed front desk. Dispatch must correct the conflicting note.

Teach this move

An address can identify a building without identifying the consignee. Ask a narrow question and repeat the answer.

Vocabulary to check: consignee, delivery window, stop sequence, delivery instruction.

Model response

Shipment 418 names suite 4, but the route note points to the rear annex. Could you confirm which entrance receives Alder Books deliveries? I need the receiving location for this shipment, not just the building address. I'll ask dispatch to correct the note once we have that distinction clear.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised question links the direction to the named recipient.

Second-round challenge

Dispatch asks whether all deliveries use the front desk. Limit the correction to Alder Books.

Language-check answers

1. B - confirm Correct. 'Confirm' is the base verb after 'should.'
2. C - delivery instruction Correct. The incorrect detail concerns the receiving location.

05 • Conversations

1. The annex belongs to another tenant - Parked at Mill Street, the driver calls Alder Books about shipment 418.
2. Two businesses called Pine - A driver checks an ambiguous consignee name with a shipping clerk before departure.
3. The gate note is for yesterday - A parked driver checks a delivery instruction with a site receptionist.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A building number without a unit

Label: 54 Cedar Court, Oak Tutors, three cartons. Reception serves units A and B; Oak Tutors is in B. Dispatch has no unit recorded.

Role A: Driver: ask for the full receiving identity and repeat it.

Role B: Receptionist: Oak Tutors is unit B; unit A is a different company.

Possible opening: Does this address identify your company or just the building?

Success checks

- Obtain unit B explicitly.
- Keep the three-carton shipment linked to Oak Tutors.
- Request the missing unit correction.

Add a complication: Reception says 'the second one' instead of naming the unit.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Checking shipment counts

Report a quantity discrepancy without inventing its cause.

CASE

At Finch Office Supplies, the bill of lading lists twelve cartons. Driver and receiver count eleven. Contents have not been checked; dispatch has no location for the twelfth carton.

Teach this move

A carton count and a product count answer different questions. Name the unit and evidence.

Vocabulary to check: bill of lading, piece count, short shipment, packing list.

Model response

The bill of lading lists twelve cartons, and we have counted eleven together. That is a one-carton difference, not a confirmed count of missing individual products. Could we record the carton shortage against this shipment reference? Dispatch will investigate the remaining carton; I don't have its location or a replacement date.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction prevents a carton difference from becoming an invented product shortage.

Second-round challenge

A colleague says one missing carton means twelve missing products. Ask for the packing detail.

Language-check answers

1. D - carton Correct. Eleven refers to the outer cartons counted.
2. A - a one-carton difference against the document Correct. Twelve listed versus eleven counted confirms this difference.

05 • Conversations

1. Eleven cartons at Finch - The driver and receiver compare the physical delivery with its bill of lading.
2. Bundles counted as pieces - At a print shop, a driver and receiver clarify the counting unit.
3. Two orders on one counter - A driver checks a shop's apparent overdelivery.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A pallet count mistaken for a carton count

Shipment P31 lists two pallets containing eighteen cartons in total. Receiver initially reports sixteen cartons missing after seeing '2' on the transport summary.

Role A: Driver: clarify which unit the summary counts.

Role B: Receiver: confirm two pallets are present; carton contents remain unchecked.

Possible opening: Does that two refer to pallets or cartons?

Success checks

- Distinguish pallets from cartons.
- Confirm only the two visible pallets.
- Leave the carton count explicitly unverified.

Add a complication: Receiver wants the eighteen cartons marked as counted before the contents check.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Updating an arrival estimate

Give a delay message with an explicit unresolved booking.

CASE

Driver is parked and calls dispatch at 10:20. Estimated arrival is 11:40; receiver's cutoff is 11:30. No later slot is confirmed. Dispatch can contact receiving and update the driver by 10:40.

Teach this move

A later estimate does not extend a cutoff. Agree the next message time without promising delivery.

Vocabulary to check: estimated time of arrival, receiving cutoff, delay notice, revised appointment.

Model response

I'm parked and calling about stop five. The estimated arrival is now 11:40, ten minutes after the receiver's 11:30 cutoff. A later appointment hasn't been confirmed. Please check whether receiving can offer another slot and update me by 10:40. I can't describe the original window as achievable on the current estimate.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The two times explain why dispatch needs to act.

Second-round challenge

The receiver offers tomorrow at nine. Explain that dispatch still needs to confirm the revised plan.

Language-check answers

1. D - after Correct. 'After' states the time relationship.
2. A - estimate Correct. An estimate communicates expected, not guaranteed, timing.

05 • Conversations

1. Ten minutes beyond the cutoff - A parked driver calls dispatch at 10:20 about stop five.
2. Early does not mean booked - A parked driver discusses an early arrival with a receiver.
3. A range instead of a sharp promise - A driver calls a customer from a parked vehicle about an uncertain arrival.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An event delivery with an earlier cutoff

A venue's event starts at 18:00, but receiving closes at 16:00. Current arrival estimate is 16:20. Dispatch can request a new arrangement but none exists.

Role A: Driver: explain why the event time is not the receiving deadline.

Role B: Venue assistant: the event team cannot approve delivery exceptions; receiving can.

Possible opening: Does six o'clock refer to the event or the last delivery?

Success checks

- State the 16:00 receiving cutoff.
- Keep venue opening separate from goods acceptance.
- Ask receiving for a confirmed alternative.

Add a complication: Someone suggests calling 16:20 'before closing' because the venue stays open.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Describing a delivery exception

Agree factual wording while preserving the receiver's concern.

CASE

At Grove Studio, one carton has a crushed lower corner. Contents remain unopened. Receiver wants the receipt to say 'broken equipment caused by driver.' Driver can record visible condition, not establish unseen damage or fault.

Teach this move

Packaging damage, possible product damage, and responsibility are separate claims.

Vocabulary to check: visible damage, exception note, delivery receipt, concealed damage.

Model response

The lower corner of this carton is crushed; that is what we can both see. We haven't inspected the contents, and I can't establish when the damage occurred. Could the exception note describe the crushed corner without stating that the equipment is broken or assigning responsibility? The claim review can consider further evidence.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The statement is specific without claiming unseen damage.

Second-round challenge

The customer asks whether the note guarantees compensation. Separate a record from a claim decision.

Language-check answers

1. B - uninspected Correct. The contents have not yet been inspected.
2. C - the visible packaging condition Correct. The observable fact concerns the carton packaging.

05 • Conversations

1. A crushed corner, not a proven cause - At Grove Studio, a driver discusses an exception note with the receiver.
2. Wet packaging without a product conclusion - A receiver and driver discuss a damp patch on a stationary carton.
3. The wrong color on the exception note - A driver corrects a description before the receiver confirms it.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A torn label and an intact carton

Carton 6 has a torn address label but no visible carton damage. Receiver fears the order reference may be misread; matching paperwork shows K88.

Role A: Driver: distinguish label condition from package damage.

Role B: Receiver: request a reference check, not a product-damage claim.

Possible opening: Is the damage to the label, the carton, or both?

Success checks

- Describe the torn label only.
- Confirm K88 using matching paperwork.
- Correct the unsupported contents claim.

Add a complication: A colleague calls it 'damaged contents' in a verbal summary.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

When the recipient cannot receive

Identify what can be arranged within the customer's constraints.

CASE

At 14:10, driver is outside Marlow Design's closed receiving office. Listed contact answers and can return at 15:00. Driver cannot commit to waiting; dispatch can review redelivery, while collection availability is unknown.

Teach this move

An attempted delivery is not completed delivery. Separate confirmed options from possibilities.

Vocabulary to check: delivery attempt, recipient unavailable, redelivery, collection point.

Model response

I reached your receiving office at 14:10, but no recipient was available. I understand you can return at 15:00; I can't confirm that this route can wait until then. We can ask dispatch about redelivery. Collection may be another option, but its location and availability still need confirmation before you travel.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The response offers a concrete request without implying an unattended handover.

Second-round challenge

The customer prefers collection. Confirm the preference without inventing a collection appointment.

Language-check answers

1. D - visit Correct. The visit occurred without a completed handover.
2. A - once Correct. Confirmation must come first.

05 • Conversations

1. A closed office at Marlow - Parked outside Marlow Design at 14:10, the driver calls the listed contact.
2. The person answering cannot receive - A delivery driver checks who can accept a shipment at a shared office.
3. A redelivery request with no slot yet - A parked driver explains an exception update to a customer.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A recipient returns after the attempt

A delivery attempt occurred at 11:05. At 11:20 the customer calls back. The route has moved on; a same-day return has not been reviewed.

Role A: Driver: acknowledge the callback and request a dispatch decision.

Role B: Customer: you are available until 13:00 and tomorrow after 10:00.

Possible opening: I'm back now; does that automatically put me next on your route?

Success checks

- Confirm the availability periods.
- Do not promise a route change.
- Explain the difference between request and confirmation.

Add a complication: The customer interprets 'request sent' as 'driver returning.'

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Explaining the booked service boundary

Explain a service mismatch and offer a booking review.

CASE

A household delivery is booked curbside. Customer requests upstairs placement. Driver cannot add inside service; dispatch can review an upgrade or rearrangement. No price or timing is known.

Teach this move

State the service boundary without judging the customer. An upgrade request is not confirmation.

Vocabulary to check: curbside delivery, inside delivery, access restriction, service level.

Model response

Your booking shows curbside delivery, whereas you need the cartons taken upstairs. That additional service isn't included in the booking I have, and I can't add it here. I can contact dispatch to review an inside-delivery option or rearrangement. We'll need the service details confirmed before promising a location, price, or date.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The response identifies the mismatch and a useful contact.

Second-round challenge

The customer offers informal cash. Keep the request within the company's booking review without inventing a fee.

Language-check answers

1. D - change Correct. Upstairs placement would change the currently booked service.
2. A - pending Correct. 'Pending review' means awaiting a decision.

05 • Conversations

1. The upstairs request - A driver and customer compare curbside service with the customer's expectation.
2. Receiving moved behind a restricted entrance - A parked driver speaks with a site contact about a new access condition.

3. A lobby is not every interior room - A driver clarifies the booked handover location at an office.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A requested time outside the booking

A business booked weekday delivery, but a customer asks the driver for Sunday service. Dispatch reviews weekend options; price and availability are unknown.

Role A: Driver: explain the current service and relay the request.

Role B: Customer: Sunday is preferred; Tuesday afternoon also works.

Possible opening: Does my weekday booking include a Sunday visit?

Success checks

- State the weekday booking.
- Give both customer preferences to dispatch.
- Avoid an invented Sunday price or promise.

Add a complication: Customer thinks a driver's willingness establishes company availability.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Matching a return to its collection

Clarify the identity and quantity of goods offered for collection.

CASE

Return R62 lists two printer cartons. Customer presents them and a third carton of cables without a matching reference. Dispatch can query the additional carton; the original two are identifiable.

Teach this move

Wanting to return an item does not automatically match it to a collection booking.

Vocabulary to check: return authorization, collection reference, refused delivery, return label.

Model response

Collection R62 covers two printer cartons, and both match the booking. The cable carton has no matching reference, so I need to query it separately. Is there another return authorization for that carton? I can report the additional request, but I can't describe it as included in R62 without confirmation.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The distinction preserves the confirmed collection and identifies the unresolved extra.

Second-round challenge

The cables came in the same purchase. Explain why that does not prove they share the collection reference.

Language-check answers

1. D - additional Correct. It adds to the booking.
2. A - unavailable Correct. Absence is described as recipient unavailable.

05 • Conversations

1. A third carton beside R62 - A driver checks a return collection with a customer.
2. Refusal because of a reported duplicate - A driver speaks with a receiver who declines a shipment.
3. The label points to an old return - A driver checks a collection label before matching it to the booking.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | One collection split between two contacts

Pickup C44 covers four cartons at Delta Studio. Reception has two; the stockroom has two. Both contacts think the driver is collecting only theirs.

Role A: Driver: establish the total and each location's contribution.

Role B: Receptionist: confirm your two and connect the stockroom contact.

Possible opening: Does four mean here at reception or across the whole collection?

Success checks

- Keep the overall booking at four.
- Separate each contact's confirmed two.
- Do not claim the stockroom handover has occurred.

Add a complication: Reception offers to confirm receipt of all four before the stockroom is checked.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Closing a route with a clear handoff

Provide enough detail to avoid an unnecessary repeat delivery.

CASE

Route 12 is ending. Stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05 but its receipt has not uploaded. Stop 8 was refused because the customer reported a duplicate order. Evening dispatcher Jo will check the receipt and contact customer service about stop 8.

Teach this move

A missing upload is not automatically a failed delivery. Preserve the event, record status, and next owner.

Vocabulary to check: proof of delivery, outstanding stop, dispatch log, follow-up owner.

Model response

For route 12, stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05, but the receipt upload is still pending. Stop 8 was refused; the customer said the order was a duplicate. Jo, please take the receipt follow-up and pass the refusal to customer service. Can you confirm those two items remain distinct in the dispatch log?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The handoff distinguishes two different exceptions.

Second-round challenge

Another screen labels both stops 'exception.' Explain the different events beneath that label.

Language-check answers

1. A - upload Correct. The receipt's transmission, not the handover, remains pending.
2. A - report Correct. A report preserves the unverified account without confirming duplication.

05 • Conversations

1. Received goods, pending upload - A driver hands route 12 to evening dispatcher Jo.
2. A corrected contact number for tomorrow - A driver hands a confirmed information change to the next dispatcher.

3. A return that has not reached the depot - A returning driver gives the desk a status update from a parked vehicle.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Two pending items with different owners

Route 4 ends with receipt upload U8 assigned to evening dispatch and a return-label query R7 assigned to returns desk. Neither is resolved.

Role A: Driver: hand over each item to its actual owner.

Role B: Dispatcher: accept U8 but explain that returns desk owns R7; its contact is Imani.

Possible opening: Which of these two follow-ups are you taking personally?

Success checks

- Name evening dispatch for U8.
- Name Imani at returns for R7.
- Request acknowledgment without calling either issue resolved.

Add a complication: Dispatcher says 'I'll pass it on' without identifying the recipient.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases, names, quantities, schedules, and company arrangements are fictional English practice, not driving, loading, cargo-handling, legal, or safety training. Service terms and duties vary. Follow employer training and applicable requirements; refer vehicle operation, access safety, claims, fees, and regulatory decisions to responsible qualified people. Phone conversations take place while parked, never while driving.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Heavy and Tractor-Trailer Truck Drivers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/heavy-and-tractor-trailer-truck-drivers.htm>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Delivery Truck Drivers and Driver/Sales Workers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/delivery-truck-drivers-and-driver-sales-workers.htm>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.